

Alexander Key

Senior Developer

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Senior Ruby on Rails developer with 10 years shipping and operating production Rails applications end to end, from architecture, Stripe payments, and Hotwire front ends to PostgreSQL and the Linux servers and CI/CD pipelines behind them. Led small teams through three ground-up rebuilds of legacy platforms onto modern Rails, most recently a Rails 3 to Rails 8 rewrite.

Experience

Lead Developer — Reservation Genie, Austin, TX 2023 – Present

- Rebuilt a legacy Rails 3 reservation platform from greenfield on Ruby on Rails 8, PostgreSQL, and Hotwire, leading a small team to deliver reservations, rentals, private charters, and digital waivers at 50,000+ reservations a year.
- Built the payment system behind every booking on Stripe Connect (connected accounts, platform fees, webhooks, refunds) plus an ActiveMerchant layer for Authorize.Net, NMI, and TrustCommerce, processing 8 figures in revenue per year.
- Increased client reservations 30% by launching white-labeled booking subdomains (e.g. book.hauntedatx.com) with host-aware routing and cookie scoping, so UTM and Google Ads attribution survives from the client's site through purchase and clients can see which channels convert.

Lead Developer — Tally Meals, Austin, TX 2022 – 2023

- Replaced a failing legacy .NET platform for Greek house meal management by leading a small team through a ground-up Ruby on Rails rebuild, owning architecture, servers, and CI/CD from first commit to a launch serving chapters across multiple universities.
- Shipped iOS and Android apps from a single Rails codebase using Hotwire Native, letting members reserve meals and late plates against chef-published menus with per-member allergy and dietary tracking, meal-plan limits and billing compliance, and printable kitchen prep lists.
- Carried every client's historical data through the replatform by converting the legacy MSSQL database to PostgreSQL, reverse-engineering the old schema and migrating chapters, members, meal plans, and reservation history into the new Rails domain model.

Senior Developer — 88 Restaurants, Austin, TX 2017 – 2022

- Split the restaurant product out of a shared legacy Rails codebase into a greenfield multi-tenant platform spanning online ordering, reservations, live table management, loyalty, and marketing automation, leading a small team and personally authoring 4,400+ commits across 280K lines of application code, a 140-table MySQL schema, and a 359-file RSpec suite, owning the stack from schema design to production servers.
- Processed 8 figures in payment volume by architecting the online ordering system end to end: Stripe checkout and refunds, Stripe Connect onboarding so restaurants are paid directly, Uber Direct delivery integration, order scheduling, gift cards and ticketed events, and a full catering system.
- Delivered the platform's most complex feature, live table management, by building real-time table-state synchronization across every device in the restaurant with ActionCable WebSockets, a drag-and-drop floor-plan editor, and an availability engine, giving front-of-house staff a single live view of the floor.

Full-Stack Developer — Austin City Guide, Austin, TX 2016 – 2017

- Modernized a city guide platform running on a decade-old .NET codebase by rebuilding it from the ground up in Ruby on Rails and PostgreSQL as sole developer.
- Achieved #1 Google rankings for multiple competitive local keywords by pairing the rebuild with aggressive on-page SEO: content structure, technical optimization, and page-speed work.
- Increased click-through rates on the site's highest-traffic pages by building in-house analytics and an A/B split-testing framework in Rails, measuring real user behavior and then iterating page layouts against live traffic.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science — Texas State University, San Marcos, TX

Skills

Back End: Ruby, Ruby on Rails (3 – 8), Active Record, Active Job, ActionCable, Action Mailer, Active Merchant, Stripe, RSpec, Sidekiq, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, REST APIs, Twilio, Postmark, Uber Direct

Front End: Hotwire (Turbo & Stimulus), Hotwire Native (iOS & Android), JavaScript, TailwindCSS, Bootstrap

Infrastructure: Linux, Kamal, Dokku, Nginx, GitHub Actions